UU-F-00370(GSA-FSS)
January 30, 1968

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILE, WORK ORGANIZER

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers expansible book and pocket type multiple compartment work organizer files indexed for general office use.

1.2 Classification. The work organizer files covered by this specification shall be of the following types, styles, and sizes:

Type I - Book Type
  Style A - Alphabetically indexed
    Size 1 - Letter size
    Size 2 - Legal size
  Style B - Numberically indexed
    Size 1 - Letter size
    Size 2 - Legal size

Type II - Pocket type (Bellows)
  Style A - Alphabetically indexed
  Style B - Numerically indexed

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

FSC 7320

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form and part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI)

Publications:

T-410 OS-61	Basis Weight of paper and paperboard
T-411 OS-[illegible]	Thickness and density of paper
T-414 TS-65	Internal tearing resistance of paper
T-423 OS-50	Folding endurance of paper
T807 SU-65	Bursting strength of paperboard and linerboard

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, New York 10017)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Materials used in the manufacture of work organizer files shall comply with the physical characteristics and other requirements specified herein and shall be entirely suitable for the application in which they are used.

3.1.1 Type I - Book type.

3.1.1.1 Paper Stock. Paper stock shall be gray kraft board or gray wallet stock having a soil resistant high finish and shall conform to the physical requirements specified in Table I and shall be entirely free from groundwood pulp.

3.1.1.2 Cover material. Cover material shall be flexible vinyl film or artificial leather as specified in the invitation to bid (6.2) and shall have a finish simulating fine grain leather. Cover material shall conform to the physical requirements specified in Table I. The artifical leather shall be composed of new cotton rag fibers which are beater impregnated with latex and pyroxylin coated.

3.1.1.3 Reinforcing tape. The reinforcing tape shall be a starch filled or synthetic resin coated woven tape having not less than 60 yarns per inch in the warp direction and not less than 50 yarns per inch in the fill direction and shall be not less than 3/4 inch wide.

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TABLE I. Physical properties of materials for Type I (Minimum)

	Paper Stock	Cover Stock
Basis weight (24 x 36 -500) pounds	142	15
ounces per sq. yd.	—	
Thickness, inch	0.0095	
Artificial leather	—	.020
sheet vinyl	—	.018
Bursting strength, PSI	112	
Tear resistance,		
Machine direction	190 (grams)	56 (Kilograms)
Cross machine direction	290 (grams)	30 (Kilograms)
Folding endurance, M.I.T.		
Machine direction	—	14,000
Cross machine direction	—	4,500

3.1.2 Type II. Pocket type.

3.1.2.1 Paper Stock. Paper stock shall be red wallet stock having a soil resistant high finish and shall conform to the physical requirements specified in Table II and shall be entirely free of groundwood pulp. The front and back cover paper shall be imprinted to simulate leather.

3.1.2.2 Paperboard. The reinforcing ply used in the file front and back shall be red lined or stained and smooth one side paperboard not less than 0.077 inch thick.

3.1.2.3 Reinforcing tape. The reinforcing tape shall be a starch filled or synthetic resin coated woven tape having not less than 60 yarns per inch in the warp direction and not less than 50 yarns per inch in the fill direction and shall be not less than 5/8 inch wide.

TABLE II. Physical properties of materials for Type II (Minimum)

	Partition stock	Gusset stock
Basis weight (24 x 36 - 500) pounds	150	105
Thickness, inch	0.011	0.0075
Bursting strength, PSI	110	80
Tear resistance, grams		
Machine direction	260	140
Cross machine direction	360	210

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3.1.3 Adhesive. The adhesive shall be of a type commonly used for bonding paper in commercial practice. When used in multi-ply constructions and seams, the adhesive shall bond securely and shall show fiber failure over the entire area of adhesive application when plies are separated by hand, as specified in 4.2.3.

3.2 Design.

3.2.1 Type I. Book type. The book type work organizer file shall be designed in the style of a book with front and back covers and with each compartment separated by leaves. The compartments shall be open on top, bottom and right side and the left sides of the compartments shall be joined by a gusset arrangement permitting expansion of each compartment. Style A files shall have not less than twenty compartments and the separators (leaves) shall be tabbed and indexed from A to Z. Style B files shall have thirty one compartments and the separators (leaves) shall be tabbed and indexed from 1 to 31. The tabs shall project in sequence from top to bottom and front to back and each tab shall project sufficiently beyond the front cover and the preceding tab to provide ready visibility. Compartment separators shall have a centrally located see-through hole or shall have a multiple see-through holes equidistant from the center. The inside of the front cover shall have an index sheet which is marked in coordination with the index tab marking. Each indexed line on the sheet shall provide a minimum of five inches of write-in space.

Style A files shall be expansible to not less than twenty inches and style B files shall be expansible to not less than thirty inches.

3.2.2 Pocket type. The design of the pocket type work organizer file shall be a series of pocket-like compartments open at the top and closed at sides and bottom by a gusset arrangement permitting collapsing and expansion of each compartment. The file shall be capable of standing unsupported with the open side of the compartments at the top. The partitions between each compartment shall be indexed at the top and step or thumb cut to permit index marking to be visible from a foot in front of the file when viewed from a height three inches above the level of the top of the file. Each compartment shall be indexed successively from front to back and left to right in a single series of cuts or in two series of cuts. Style A files shall have not less than twenty compartments indexed from A to Z and style B files shall have thirty one compartments indexed from 1 to 31 when specified in the invitation to bid, the file shall have a flap, which is an extension of the back of the file not less than ten inches in length and designed to fold over the open top of the compartments. The flap shall have an elastic cord suitable for encircling the file to retain the flap in a closed position.

Style A files shall be expansible to not less than fifteen inches and Style B files shall be expansible to not less than twenty two inches.

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Type I - Book type. The book type files shall be constructed with the gusset extending the entire length of the hinge side. The gusset shall be an extension of each compartment separator accurately folded and overlapped onto the adjacent compartment separator not less than 3/4 inch, or shall be accurately folded separate gussets joining adjacent compartment separators by overlapping onto each not less than 3/4 inch. The gusset shall overlap on front and back covers not less than 1-1/2 inches. The outside of the gusset shall be reinforced at each edge by a tape conforming to 3.1.1.3 which shall be bonded to the gusseting throughout its entire surface by an adhesive meeting the requirements of 3.1.3.

The index sheet shall be securely bonded over its entire surface to the inside of the front cover.

The indexing shall be imprinted on the tabs in a block style and in a vertical position. Letters and numbers shall be black and not less than 3/16 inch in height. The index tab shall

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have a protective shield of clear plastic not less than 0.005 inch thick. The see-through holes in all compartment separators shall be in alignment. Centrally located holes shall be not less than 3/4 inch in diameter and multiple holes shall be not less than 1/4 inch in diameter.

3.3.2 Type II - Pocket type. The pocket type files shall have both back and front of multiple ply construction of materials conforming to 3.1.2 and 3.1.3. The grain direction of the front and back shall be parallel and the grain direction of the plies shall cross. The paper stock on the exterior of the front and back shall extend over the top of the paperboard ply a minimum of one inch into the interior. The gusset shall be made of stock conforming to the requirements of 3.1.2.1 and shall be of one piece construction reinforced along the exterior top edge by reinforcing tape conforming to 3.1.2.3. The gusset shall be accurately folded for the required number of compartments and securely bonded between plies of the front and back. The compartment partitions shall be securely affixed to the gussets along the full height of each side and shall be accurately located with respect to the gusset folds. Partitions shall be folded over at the top to form two plies along the top edge.

Index letters and numbers shall be imprinted in black and shall be in block style in a verticle position not less than 3/16 inch in height.

3.4 Dimensions. The minimum width and height dimensions shall be as shown in table III.

TABLE III Minimum width and height dimensions(inches)

	Width	Height
Type I		
Size 1	9 7/16	11 7/16
Size 2	9 7/16	14 7/16
Type II	9 7/8	11 7/8

3.5 Color. Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, Type I file covers shall be black or dark blue and the compartment separators shall be gray as specified in 3.1.1.1. Type II files shall be red or brown and the exterior shall simulate the appearance and color of leather.

3.6 Workmanship. Files shall be clean and free from dirt spots, holes, tears or wrinkles and shall have a uniform finish. All folds and bends shall be neatly and accurately made and the files shall be free of defects which adversely affect their appearance or might impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary

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4.1.1 Inspection of materials. The supplier is responsible for assuring that materials conform to the physical properties specified in 3.1.1 and 3.1.2.

4.2 Sampling and inspection of materials. Materials shall be tested for the applicable physical properties listed in Tables I and II. A lot shall consist of one shipment of paper, tape or cover stock used in the manufacture of the files and received at one time from one source of supply, and shall be expressed in pounds of paper, yards of tape and square yards of cover stock, as applicable. The sample unit shall be 1000 square inches of paper used to make gussets, leaves, partitions, flaps, and 1½ yards of tape and 1 square yard of cover stock. The sample units shall be selected from each lot of paper, tape and cover stock in accordance with table IV.

TABLE IV - Sample size

Pounds of paper, yards of tape, or square yards of cover stock	Sample Size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

4.2.1 Physical properties testing. The physical properties of component materials shall be tested in accordance with the applicable Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry test methods listed in table V, to assure compliance with the requirements listed in tables I and II.

TABLE V - Physical properties testing

Physical property	TAPPI Test Method
Basis weight (24x36 - 500)	T 410 os-61
Thickness	T 411 os-44
Folding endurance M.I.T.	T 423 os-50
Tearing resistance	T 414 ts-65
Bursting strength	T 807 su-65

4.2.2 Thread count. The specimen for this test shall be one piece of tape 3 inches long from each sample unit. A distance of one inch shall be measured and the number of yarns per inch in the filling direction counted. The specimen shall then be pulled apart at the end and the number of yarns in the warp direction counted. The count shall comply with the requirement of 3.1.1.3 or 3.1.2.3, as applicable.

4.2.3 Adhesive. The specimen for this test shall be one book or pocket type file, as applicable. There shall be no failure of the glue bond when all seams, plies and laps are separated by hand, as evidenced by fibers showing where the separation occurs.

4.3 Sampling and inspection of the end item. Sample work organizer files shall be inspected for the defects listed in table VI. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be 1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects

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per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one work organizer file and the lot size shall be all work organizer files of one type, style and size offered for acceptance at one time.

TABLE VI - Inspection for end item defects

Examine	Defect
Type, class and size when applicable	Not as specified
Type I - Book type	
Material	Not suitable for application in which used. Paper stock not gray Kraft board or gray wallet. Paper stock does not have soil resistant high finish. Cover material not flexible vinyl film or artificial leather, as specified. Cover material finish does not simulate fine grain leather. Reinforcing tape not starch filled or synthetic resin coated.
Design	Not in style of book with front and back covers. Gusset not on left side. Style A file has less than twenty compartments. Style B files have less than thirty one compartments. Index tabs not as specified. No see-through hole in compartment separators. No index sheet on inside of front cover. Index sheet write-in space less than five inches. Index sheet marking not coordinated with index tab marking. Style A files expansible less than twenty inches. Style B files expansible less than thirty inches.
Construction	Gusset does not extend entire length of hinge side. Gusset not accurately folded. Gusset overlaps onto compartment separator less than 3/4 inch. Gusset overlaps on covers less than 1 1/2 inches. Gusset not reinforced at each edge by tape as required. Index sheet not bonded as required. Index marking on tabs not as specified. Index tabs do not have clear plastic shield 0.005 inch or more in thickness. See-through holes not in alignment or not specified size.
Type II - Pocket type	
Material	Not suitable for application in which used Paper stock not red wallet. Paper stock does not have soil resistant high finish.

(Con't.)

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TABLE VI - Inspection for end item defects (Con't.)

Examine	Defect
Type II - Pocket type	
Material (Con't.)	Cover paper not imprinted to simulate leather. Paper board reinforcing ply less than 0.077 inch thick. Paper board not red lined or stained and smooth one side. Reinforcing tape not starch filled or synthetic resin coated.
Design	Not as specified. File will not stand unsupported. File not indexed as required. Index markings not visible when viewed as specified. Indexing not in one or two series of steps. Style A file has less than twenty compartments. Style B file has less than thirty one compartments. Flap, when specified, missing or not as required. Elastic flap cord missing or not as required. Style A files expansible to less than fifteen inches. Style B files expansible to less than twenty two inches.
Construction	Back and front not multiple ply construction. Exterior paper stock does not extend over top into interior - a minimum of one inch. Gusset not one piece construction. Gusset not reinforced by tape along exterior top edge. Gusset not accurately folded. Compartment partitions not securely affixed to gussets along full height of each side or not accurately located with gusset folds. Partitions not two plies along top edge. Index letters not imprinted as required.
Dimensions	Not as specified in table III.
Color	Type I file covers not as specified. Type II compartment separators not gray. Type II files not as specified.
Workmanship	Files not free from dirt spots, holes, tears or wrinkles. Finish not uniform. Folds or bends not neatly and accurately made.

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4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table VII. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE VII - Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior container)	Number per container is more or less than required.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I. Each type I file shall be inserted in a kraft envelope or wrapped with kraft paper, cellophane or plastic. The envelope or wrap shall be secured. Six files of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.2 Type II. Six type II files of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The bellows side of the file shall be alternated. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I or II. The type I or II files shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The files shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Type I or II. Six unit packages of type I or II files of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

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5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I or II. Six unit packages of type I or II files of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The files shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. In addition unit packages shall be marked with Federal Stock Number, nomenclature and quantity.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. These work organizer files are intended for general office use in separating, arranging and filing papers and as a sequence file for holding papers in a follow-up system.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number and date of this specification
(b) Type and class, and size when applicable (see 1.2)
(c) Cover material, when applicable (see 3.1.1.2).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Markings required (see 5.3)

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Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
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Contents (exterior container)	Number per container is more or less than required.

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5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I. Each type I file shall be inserted in a kraft envelope or wrapped with kraft paper, cellophane or plastic. The envelope or wrap shall be secured. Six files of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.2 Type II. Six type II files of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The bellows side of the file shall be alternated. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I or II. The type I or II files shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The files shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Type I or II. Six unit packages of type I or II files of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

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5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I or II. Six unit packages of type I or II files of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The files shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. In addition unit packages shall be marked with Federal Stock Number, nomenclature and quantity.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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(c) Cover material, when applicable (see 3.1.1.2).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Markings required (see 5.3)

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